

PROSPER AWUNI

Threat Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, MITRE ATT&CK, Microsoft Defender, Azure Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an experienced Threat Detection Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience building high-impact detection capabilities to protect sensitive data and digital infrastructure at scale. I have strong proficiency in KQL (Kusto Query Language) and hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (O365), alongside exposure to Azure cloud logging environments. I am deeply familiar with attacker Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) and the MITRE ATT&CK Framework, which I apply to develop and tune threat-led detection rules, threat hunting queries and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks. I approach detection engineering not as a traditional Security Operations Centre (SOC) function but as a craft of building precise, high-fidelity detections that translate threat intelligence and adversary techniques into actionable, automated defensive capabilities. I am motivated by the challenge of protecting sensitive and high-value data environments where the quality of detection directly affects the resilience of the organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection rule development, threat-led detection design, tuning and maintenance, detection-as-code principles, MITRE ATT&CK TTP mapping
- **SIEM and Threat Hunting:** Microsoft Sentinel SIEM (Security Information and Event Management), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Insight, proactive threat hunting, anomaly investigation
- **Endpoint and Office Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (O365), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response)
- **Cloud Logging and Azure Security:** Azure cloud logging, Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Azure Monitor, cloud-native detection coverage
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks, Logic Apps automation, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows, PowerShell scripting
- **Threat Intelligence and Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK Framework, attacker TTPs, threat intelligence integration, NIST 800-61 Incident Response
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera BAS (Breach and Attack Simulation), Nessus, AppCheck
- **Identity and Access Security:** BeyondTrust PAM (Privileged Access Management), MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication), SSO (Single Sign-On)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Developed and maintained high-impact threat detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, translating threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK TTPs into actionable, high-fidelity detections
- Performed proactive threat hunting across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying attacker activity that evaded automated detection and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD)
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Office 365 (O365) across an 8,000-user estate, extending detection coverage across endpoints and email
- Leveraged Azure cloud logging and Entra ID audit logs for cloud-native threat detection, developing detections for identity-based attacks and anomalous Azure activity

- Built and maintained SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating responses to common threat scenarios and freeing analyst capacity for high-complexity investigations
- Mapped detection gaps to the MITRE ATT&CK Framework, systematically improving coverage across key TTP categories relevant to the organisation's threat profile
- Led incident response investigations using NIST 800-61, applying MITRE ATT&CK analysis to understand adversary behaviour and inform detection improvements post-incident
- Managed vulnerability management using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, Nessus and AppCheck, validating detection capability against simulated attack scenarios

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Developed and tuned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, improving alert fidelity and reducing false positive rates across the SOC (Security Operations Centre)
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using KQL to investigate suspicious behaviour patterns in Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, mapping findings to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Office 365, investigating endpoint and email-borne threats and refining detection configurations
- Monitored Azure cloud logging and Entra ID activity for anomalous sign-in behaviour, cloud resource misuse and identity-based attack indicators
- Automated alert triage and containment workflows using Sentinel SOAR playbooks, reducing analyst workload on repetitive, low-complexity threats
- Supported incident response investigations, applying NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK to understand attacker TTPs and improve detection rules based on lessons learned

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security tooling and infrastructure in a SaaS/FinTech environment, including endpoint protection, access management and security monitoring
- Supported security monitoring, incident triage and configuration management, contributing to a robust security baseline

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed a comprehensive library of KQL-based threat detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, measurably improving detection coverage across the attack lifecycle
- Built Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks that automated initial triage and containment for common attack patterns, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume alert types
- Used Pentera BAS to simulate attacker TTPs against UAL's security controls, validating detection rule effectiveness and identifying gaps in coverage prior to a real-world incident
- Led multiple high-severity incident response investigations at UAL, applying MITRE ATT&CK mapping to understand adversary behaviour and directly improving post-incident detection rules
- Extended detection coverage to Azure cloud logging environments, creating detections for identity compromise and cloud-native attack techniques relevant to the organisation's Azure estate
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, demonstrating effective application of controls to protect against common TTPs including phishing, credential misuse and malware deployment

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security Plus (Security+)
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A Plus (A+)
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

